

How do you assess the applicant's personal potential and academic abilities?

Mr Otto possesses exceptionally high academic potential. His ability to draw complex connections across different academic disciplines is remarkable. This became particularly evident in his written term paper for my course *"Technology, Society and the Firm"*, which he completed in collaboration with four fellow students.

In this paper, Mr Otto analysed the political and economic development of Vietnam within the tension between capitalism and communism. He combined a solid understanding of historical and political contexts with economic analysis, demonstrating how ideological frameworks shape economic structures. His analytical depth and ability to apply theoretical concepts critically reflect intellectual maturity and interdisciplinary thinking.

In class discussions, Mr Otto consistently contributes thoughtful and well-connected insights that elevate the intellectual level of debate. I therefore value his participation in my course very highly.

How do you assess the applicant's motivation for study?

Mr Otto comes from a small town in eastern Germany, near the former inner-German border, and has, through his own determination, reached the **Norwegian School of Economics (NHH)** – Norway's leading business school. This achievement reflects his exceptional ambition and perseverance.

Despite lacking a strong academic family background, Mr Otto displays impressive intellectual curiosity and self-motivation. At the age of only thirteen, he began engaging independently with financial markets and started investing via a junior brokerage account. This early involvement in economic topics highlights his ability to identify opportunities and take responsibility for his own learning.

His motivation is not driven solely by career aspirations but by a genuine interest in understanding economic systems. This is also evident in his **Business, Economics and Data Science** programme, where he consistently exceeds expectations and pursues his studies with enthusiasm and intellectual depth.

How do you assess the applicant's social, political, and civic engagement within and outside the university?

Mr Otto is an active and engaged member of the NHH student community. Already in his first semester, he became a member of the **Case Club**, one of the most competitive student organisations at the university. Within this club, he works on business case studies and represents NHH at national and international competitions – an involvement that requires analytical skill, teamwork, and a strong sense of responsibility.

In addition, Mr Otto actively supports academic exchange within his degree programme. Recognising that many students initially struggle with programming and data science, he voluntarily offers **weekly tutoring sessions in small groups**, helping his peers master key concepts. This commitment reflects his willingness to share knowledge and contribute positively to the academic environment.

Would you like to provide any additional information that might be relevant to the scholarship decision?

Beyond his academic achievements, Mr Otto shows a strong interest in the **start-up culture** that is actively promoted at NHH. He is currently participating in the **AI-Accelerated Innovation Lab**, a university programme focused on idea generation and venture validation.

Furthermore, Mr Otto intends to establish his own company during his undergraduate studies named "LandEi, bringing together students from different national backgrounds. The proposed founding team will consist of members from **Norway, Denmark, and Germany**, underlining his intercultural competence and ability to collaborate effectively across borders. The goal of this app is to connect consumers who value sustainable food with local farmers. Users can view and reserve products online, with collection currently taking place locally.

I am confident that Mr Otto possesses both the intellectual and personal qualities to make a valuable contribution academically and socially. I therefore **recommend him without reservation** for the scholarship offered by the Friedrich Naumann Foundation.